

onto the stage, shouting, "*Sic semper tyrannis*" ("Thus always to tyrants"), to the astonishment of the theatergoers. Upon landing, he broke his leg, but managed to limp to a horse he had waiting outside. He then fled the city. Booth's two accomplices were less successful. Powell entered William Seward's house and managed to make his way to the bedroom where the statesman was lying injured, having broken his arm and jaw in a carriage accident nine days earlier. When his gun jammed, Powell pulled a knife and stabbed his victim repeatedly, but not fatally. The brace supporting Seward's broken arm diverted the worst of the blows. When help arrived, Powell broke off the attack, exited the house, and, like Booth, escaped on a waiting horse. Seward subsequently made a full recovery. As for Atzerodt, his courage simply failed him. He spent the evening drinking in the bar of the hotel where the vice president was staying, then wandered off into the night without having even approached his target.

Owner of the boarding house where the conspirators met, Mary Surratt, hanged for her alleged part in the plot, was the first woman executed by the U.S. government.